IOWN

The Morning Brief

APRIL 23, 2026

Records Return

S&P 500 and Nasdaq notched fresh highs on a tech-led rally as LRCX beat after close; futures eased overnight on Iran.

S&P 500	NASDAQ	BRENT CRUDE	BITCOIN	FEAR & GREED
7,112 ↑1.01%	Record · ↑1.67%	~$102 ↑3%+	~$78,000 ↑5%+	46 · Fear (improving)

SECTION 01

Markets

THE TAPE REVERSED ON AI — S&P 500 AND NASDAQ CLOSED AT FRESH RECORDS

Wednesday inverted Tuesday's defensive selloff. The S&P 500 gained 1.01% to roughly 7,112 with an intraday high of 7,114 — a fresh record close, per CNBC. The Nasdaq surged 1.67% to 24,657 for a new record, the Dow added 0.69% to 49,490, and the Russell 2000 recovered 0.72%. UVXY fell 1.23%, reversing Tuesday's risk-off bid. The leadership was clean and concentrated: Tech (XLK) led at +2.20%, Energy (XLE) added 1.20%, and Communication Services (XLC) gained 0.61%. Real Estate (XLRE) lagged at −0.73% and Industrials (XLI) slipped 0.23%. S&P 500 futures eased roughly 0.38% overnight per Yahoo Finance, as Iran's seizure of two container ships in the Strait of Hormuz cooled the ceasefire-extension euphoria. The setup into today: a record-high equity market with futures modestly soft, Brent oil back above $100, and five IOWN names reporting earnings.

SEMICONDUCTORS WERE THE RALLY'S ENGINE — AMD LED AT +6.67%, TSM +5.26%, LRCX BEAT AFTER CLOSE

The AI-infrastructure sleeve delivered Wednesday's cleanest performance. AMD surged 6.67% to $303.46, TSM jumped 5.26% to $387.44, MRVL added 3.97%, CRDO rose 3.37%, COHR gained 1.94%, and NVDA advanced 1.31% to $202.50. LRCX closed up 2.78% to $265.55 into its print and then delivered the capstone result after the bell: EPS of $1.47 versus $1.38 consensus, revenue of $5.84 billion (+23.8% YoY) versus $5.70 billion expected, and June-quarter guidance at a midpoint of $6.60 billion — 9.4% above Street estimates, per StockStory and Benzinga. The stock added roughly 3.67% in extended trading. CEO Tim Archer attributed the record result to AI-driven memory and advanced-packaging capex. For the IOWN semiconductor complex (QCOM, NXPI, ADI, AMD, TSM, LRCX, KEYS, NVDA, COHR, CRDO, MRVL), the print is a direct validation of the physical-AI-infrastructure thesis the portfolio was built around.

CRYPTO BROKE HIGHER — IBIT +5.27%, ETHA +4.50%, MINERS AND COIN RALLIED IN TANDEM

The digital-asset complex posted its strongest session in weeks. IBIT rose 5.27% to $44.75 and ETHA jumped 4.50% to $18.13 as Bitcoin recovered to approximately $78,000, up roughly 5% from Tuesday's lows per CoinGlass and Fortune. HUT and MARA both gained 5.43%, COIN added 5.25% to $206.24 (clawing back most of Tuesday's 7.41% drop from the NY AG lawsuit), and HOOD rose 2.31%. Benzinga attributed the move to the ceasefire extension reducing near-term risk-off pressure, with Bitcoin testing the upper end of its recent trading range. For IOWN's digital-ETF allocation, the day reinforces the hedge characteristic of the sleeve — it

decoupled from the crypto-equity regulatory overhang and traded with risk-on equities rather than against them.

TEL PRINTED A BEAT BUT FELL 9.10% — THE DISCONNECT IS INFORMATIVE

TE Connectivity reported Q2 fiscal 2026 EPS of $2.73 versus $2.70 consensus, revenue of $4.7 billion (+15% reported / +7% organic), and a book-to-bill of 1.12 on orders of $5.3 billion, per Benzinga and the company's release. Management raised the dividend 10% and guided Q3 sales to approximately $5 billion with adjusted EPS near $2.83. Despite the beat and constructive guidance, TEL closed down 9.10% at $221.04 — the portfolio's worst performer of the session. The stock traded a wide $210.78–$223.49 range. The tape reaction suggests the market was positioned for stronger organic growth or orders acceleration, and the 10% headline revenue-growth guide for Q3 did not clear an elevated bar. For the committee, the disconnect between the print and the price action is worth flagging: LRCX's after-hours response and TEL's session action point to the same dynamic — the AI-infrastructure trade rewards revenue acceleration, not steady compounding, in the current regime.

S&P 500	7,112 · ↑1.01% · Fresh record close
NASDAQ	24,657 · ↑1.67% · Record close
SECTOR LEADERS	Tech ↑2.20% · Energy ↑1.20% · Comm Svcs ↑0.61%
AMD / TSM	AMD ↑6.67% · TSM ↑5.26% · LRCX beat guide raise
TEL	$221.04 · ↓9.10% · Beat but soft relative to bar
CRYPTO	IBIT ↑5.27% · ETHA ↑4.50% · BTC ~$78K
CARSON'S SPY SUPPORT	$645.80 · Untouched · ~9% below current

When the S&P closes at a record on tech leadership with Brent still above $100 and the Hormuz blockade intact, the market is telling us what it values right now: AI capex is pricing faster than geopolitical risk is re-rating. Both threads continue today. **The physical world matters.**

SECTION 02

Geopolitics

IRAN SEIZED TWO SHIPS IN HORMUZ — THE CEASEFIRE IS NOW FUNCTIONALLY A BLOCKADE STANDOFF

Iran announced Wednesday that it had seized two container vessels in the Strait of Hormuz, with a third vessel coming under fire, per NPR and The Washington Post. The action came hours after Trump formally extended the ceasefire but preserved the US naval blockade. Vice President Vance said the first round of Islamabad talks broke down because Iran would not commit to forgoing a nuclear weapon, per Fox News. President Pezeshkian reiterated that Tehran wants to continue talks but that the blockade and threats are the main obstacles. Iran also stated it would not permit reopening of the Strait while the US Navy continues intercepting vessels, per CNBC. Brent crude rose more than 3% to $101.91 on the session and traded near $104 overnight per Yahoo Finance. The structure is now a durable commodity stress test: the shooting has stopped, the economic coercion continues, and shipping through a critical energy corridor is unresolved.

THE FED PATH GOT LONGER — A REUTERS POLL PUSHED THE FIRST CUT TO LATE 2026

A Reuters poll of 103 economists conducted April 17–21 found that 56 now expect the Fed's benchmark rate to remain in the 3.50–3.75% range through September, with the first cut pushed to late 2026. War-driven energy shocks and resilient March inflation data were cited as the key drivers. The repricing is consistent with Tuesday's defensive-led selloff and Wednesday's reassertion of Tech leadership: rate-sensitive duration proxies (XLRE −0.73%, XLU −0.18%, TLT +0.20% after Tuesday's −0.55%) continue to trade in line with a higher-for-longer regime, while secular-growth exposure benefits from the cash-flow durability story. For IOWN, the implication is specific: the dividend sleeve's exposure to rate-sensitive names (ATO, BKH, NEE) faces continued pressure, while the growth sleeve's AI and compounder positions — LRCX, AMD, TSM, NVDA, STLD, CAT — carry the tape. NEE reports today, which will inform how the rate-sensitive utility sub-sleeve is digesting the repricing.

WARSH'S CONFIRMATION PATH REMAINS CONTESTED — TILLIS HOLDS THE COMMITTEE LEVERAGE

Fed chair nominee Kevin Warsh completed a second day of press coverage Wednesday, with CNN and NPR both characterizing his Senate testimony as deliberately ambiguous on the rate path. Warsh told senators the economy's AI-driven productivity could give the Fed more leeway to lower rates later, but declined to commit to any specific action and rejected the "sock puppet" framing from Sen. Warren. Sen. Tillis's stated condition — that the Powell investigation close before he votes in committee — remains the binding constraint, with Republicans holding only a 12–10 advantage. The market read Wednesday was less about the hearing and more about the Fed path itself: the Reuters poll arrived alongside the hearing coverage, reinforcing the view that a functioning chair-transition does not shift the rate calculus materially. For the committee, the Warsh process is now more of a governance overhang than an active catalyst.

HORMUZ	Iran seized 2 container ships (NPR · WaPo)
TALKS	Islamabad round collapsed over nuclear commitment (Fox)
BLOCKADE	US Navy maintains · Iran: Hormuz closed while blockade stands
BRENT	~$102 · ↑3%+ · Near $104 overnight
FED POLL	First cut pushed to late 2026 (Reuters)
WARSH	Tillis block threat persists · Powell investigation is the gate

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Five IOWN names report today — LMT, FCX, NEE, ORI, SSNC span the portfolio's defense, materials, utilities, insurance, and software sleeves. LMT closed down 2.89% at $555.43 ahead of its print, consensus centered near $6.77 EPS. FCX (consensus ~$0.46) is the copper/materials read and closed up 4.13% to $70.36 on mineral-supply tailwinds from the geopolitical backdrop. NEE ($0.94 est) is the first renewable utility to report into the pushed-out rate-cut path; Morgan Stanley lowered its target by $2 this week per Yahoo. ORI ($0.80 est) and SSNC ($1.68 est) complete the day — SSNC closed down 1.09% after Jefferies lowered its target to $92 but maintained Buy. The read across five different sleeves on the same day will materially inform the IOWN thesis into the back half of earnings. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. Initial jobless claims arrive at 8:30 AM ET with consensus at 212K vs. 207K prior. The labor-market data has remained tight through the war-inflation regime; a print meaningfully above consensus would be the first crack in that resilience. S&P Global Flash PMI at 9:45 AM ET (Manufacturing est 52.5, Services est 50.0) will provide the incremental read on whether the Q2 services-economy expansion is decelerating. Kansas Fed composite follows at 11:00 AM ET. The data stack is heavy today and tilts toward growth — a constructive claims print paired with a Services PMI above 50 would validate the AI-led rally narrative; a weaker combination would reintroduce the stagflation framing that surfaced through the first weeks of the conflict. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. LRCX's post-close print is the most important IOWN tell of the week. The $6.60 billion June-quarter revenue guide at the midpoint sits 9.4% above Street expectations per StockStory, and management lifted the full-year 2026 outlook on AI-memory and advanced-packaging strength. The after-hours response (+3.67% to approximately $275) was constructive but measured relative to the magnitude of the beat and guide, suggesting positioning into the print was already elevated. The read-through to the rest of the semi-capital-equipment complex — and by extension, the broader AI-infrastructure thesis — is durable: the DRAM capex cycle the bears had been flagging is accelerating, not slowing, through the conflict. QCOM (−1.43% on UBS target trim Tuesday, +0.38% Wednesday) remains the weakest link in the complex; Barclays reinstated at Underweight with a $130 target on handset weakness per Yahoo. *Avoid Erosion.*

4. TEL's 9.10% session drawdown is a positioning signal, not a thesis break. The print itself — $2.73 EPS beat, 15% reported sales growth, 1.12 book-to-bill, 10% dividend raise — validates the physical-AI-infrastructure thesis TEL sits at the center of. The market's rejection is about expectations compression, not fundamentals. The session drawdown sends the stock meaningfully lower on the print, and the committee can assess whether the repricing creates an accumulation window as the AI-capex narrative continues to build. TEL remains one of the cleanest physical-world AI exposures in the dividend sleeve. **The physical world matters.**

5. The crypto sleeve's decoupling from the COIN legal overhang is constructive. The IBIT +5.27% and ETHA +4.50% session alongside COIN's 5.25% recovery indicates the NY AG prediction-market lawsuit is being priced as a narrow challenge to specific product lines, not a systemic threat to the asset class. HUT and MARA both +5.43% confirm the structural repricing, with Bitcoin near $78,000 per CoinGlass. The broader pattern — digital assets trading with risk-on equities rather than against — aligns with the hedge role the sleeve was designed to play. Monitoring for follow-through as the pre-market prints today. *Think Like an Owner.*

6. The Apple CEO transition is market-structure news, not an IOWN holding event. Apple announced Tuesday that Tim Cook will become executive chairman effective September 1 and hardware chief John Ternus will take the CEO role, per the company's release and Fox Business. Shares dipped initially then rebounded 2.63% to $273.17. Apple is not an IOWN holding, but the transition matters for the broader tech-leadership complex — Ternus must resolve Apple's AI strategy gap, and the market read will influence sentiment around the AI mega-cap cohort where IOWN holds NVDA, AMD, and TSM. No direct position implication, but the event belongs in the committee's peripheral vision for the cycle. **Simplicity Over Complexity.**

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